

What is a nerd?

Intelligence, obsession, social ineptitude and having suffered at the hand of the cool kids?
<http://dgit.in/R8tnfB>

**Last minute changes**

Here's a look at some games that went through drastic changes during their development cycle
<http://dgit.in/SRM8L1>

The big three of the web world

The internet is a massive place, and keeping a track of trends can be quite tedious, and comprehensiveness is absolutely unfeasible. Major trends however, are evident, and since the last month, the web has been abuzz with myriad changes, slowly moving further towards complete cloud connectivity.

Updates continued to be made to the rapidly evolving messaging, mail, and social networking platforms, essentially allowing users to more easily share and manage their content, and better connect with their contacts across the world. The usual suspects of the internet, Google, Facebook, and Microsoft, are once again the biggest movers since last month, announcing new features to existing services, rebranding older properties, and in some cases, spring-cleaning away less-used services.

The most popular search engine in the world, our window to the internet, Google Search, also got its fair share of updates, adding personalized results from Gmail, while demoting sites with copyright violation histories – an anti-piracy move that was a surprise turnaround to the search giant's previously espoused internet freedom slogan.

Outlook.com

Microsoft has released a preview version of a social network friendly online mail service called Outlook.com, the successor of the company's old Hotmail service. Microsoft is touting Outlook.com as a new free mail service that pulls in features of Hotmail and Exchange. Microsoft further says the new



Outlook Inbox with Skype dialog box



Outlook message PhotoMail

mail service has been designed for personal use. Outlook.com is integrated with Windows and Office, and can even pull in contacts from websites such as Gmail, Twitter, Facebook, Google+ and Linked. The company is working to bring Skype integration to make the email more relevant for all users.

As rumoured previously, the new mail client comes with cleaner and fresher UI, having lots of white space, similar to Google's recent facelift to Gmail. Outlook.com also uses Exchange ActiveSync, enabling users to have more control over mail, calendar and experience on the smartphone, tablet, and the new Outlook 2013 Preview. Outlook.com is also said to be compatible with Windows 8, which is sched-

uled to launch on Oct. 26. This means, the new mail service will be equally friendly to touch and mouse-and-keyboard input.

Microsoft has also introduced improved spam control features that can differentiate between important e-mails,

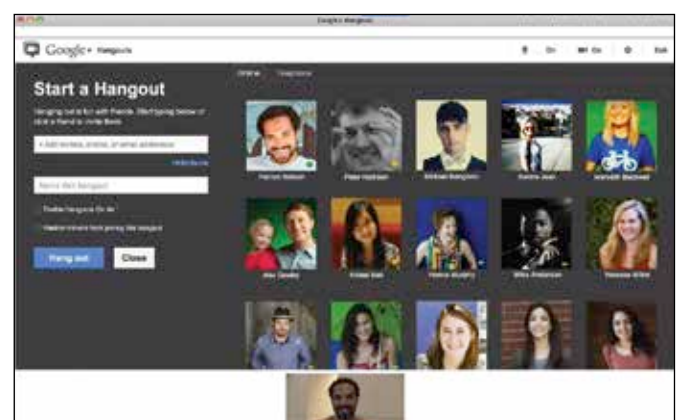
newsletters and junk mail, and place them where they belong. Launching a veiled attack on Google, Chris Jones in the blog says the company does not scan mails or attachments to show relevant ads in the mail box.

Existing Hotmail users can upgrade to Outlook.com by simply choosing the upgrade option from their Hotmail settings. Users, however, have the option to retain their same account id with @outlook.com or get a new alias. New users can simply visit Outlook.com and create a new account.

Google Round-Up

Apart from entertaining and connecting the world to the London 2012 Olympics with its competition-inducing interactive sports doodles, Google made several headlines this month. To start with, the company announced it would be replacing the Gmail video chat feature with Google+ Hangouts video chat, helping it deepen Google+ integration with Gmail, and offering better video-chat reliability and quality.

Google also announced that Google+ profiles and pages will be getting custom URLs,



Gmail-hangouts